

INTERACTION BETWEEN EXPRESSION AND IMPRESSION

Greetings, my dearest, dearest friends. Blessings for every one of you. Blessed be this evening. May this lecture help all of you to progress on this path and to find missing clues and enlightenment wherever you struggle in the dark.

Man's struggle is a continuous one towards light, whether or not he knows it. When I say light, I mean the light of truth, the truth of happiness. For, in truth, man must be happy. When he loses truth, it is always because he looks for much more complicated solutions than the truth. He looks much further ahead and away from where the answer is.

The concept that he is impressed with is that happiness is obtainable only in the distant future. So he strives towards the future, while the happiness is in the now. I have said this before, my friends, but it is not fully understood by most of you. So I want to talk about this a little more, and I want to show you the way to reach the experiencing of it.

If you truly understand yourself in relationship to this very moment, the momentary unhappiness notwithstanding, you must be happy. In other words -- and this may sound like a contradiction, but it is not -- no matter how unhappy you are now, by understanding this "now," you must be happy. And no matter how favorable circumstances are and no matter how happy you may think you are at this moment, if you do not fully live in this moment and understand it in relationship to you, you cannot be fully happy.

When I speak of the now and of the moment, this, of course, can mean only one thing: that is you yourself. For, your view of the world, your attitude to life, to happenings, and to others can only be a result of your view of and attitude toward yourself. If you understand yourself in relationship to life at this moment, you cannot possibly be in darkness.

I have given you many tools for reaching yourself and therefore to live in the now. This whole path and all its methods and various approaches are concerned with this primary goal. When man realizes himself, when he finds his real self, he is in the now -- in the very act of being in himself.

We have in our pathwork two fundamental approaches, which are both equally necessary. One is finding and expressing and emptying out what is within you so that it can be reexamined as to its truthfulness and reality. And the second is impressing, molding, and directing the powers within yourself so as to create favorable, or more favorable, circumstances. Both are interdependent. In order to live meaningfully and dynamically, an interrelationship between these two approaches is necessary. I can recognize that many of my friends -- most of them, if not, to a certain extent, all of them -- are so often in confusion regarding this happy interaction, this mutual

interplay between expressing and impressing, between emptying out and putting in truth. For, when there is no harmony between these two activities, there must be confusion and darkness.

No matter how important each of these two approaches is, each by itself used instead of the other will make the fulfillment you seek remain unattainable. It is not easy to be aware as to when one and when the other activity is appropriate. Let us try to shed a little more light on this subject.

From our past endeavors, you all know the importance of examining your unconscious thoughts and reactions. You all know that taking a truthful concept, impressing it over as yet unrecognized, untruthful ideas is merely self-deception, superimposition. It cannot create a genuine constructive attitude. Your psyche is like a vessel. If it is filled with unclear water, and you pour clear water into it, the clear water must become muddy too. So the unclear water must be emptied first. When I say it must be emptied, this means you must understand its contents. You must understand that particular misconceptions make the water muddy, and what the misconception is, and in what way it is a misconception. This is the expressing, the emptying out.

As far as expressing is concerned, one of the most important aspects is your struggle to resolve problems on false premises. The question slumbering within yourself, the question you unconsciously pose regarding a certain attitude towards life, exists on an utterly false premise. It is often a nonexistent problem in itself, or it exists in an entirely different way than you, consciously or unconsciously, consider. When you build defenses against a nonexistent problem, no matter how you struggle, no matter how you defend yourself, you must entangle yourself deeper into a web of confusion. This is the general difficulty confronting all mankind, even among those who are already on such a path of self-realization. For each one of you has yet to disentangle himself from such predicaments: struggling and defending against a false assumption, a nonexistent danger.

You have already made such discoveries, and some of you have already liberated yourselves from some of those false struggles. You have understood them to some extent, but I venture to say that every one of you here and every one of you who reads these words and who is not here tonight still struggles against a problem that does not exist.

Let us take a very simple common example so as to make it easier for you to follow me. Every one of you is constantly afraid in one way or another of being inadequate, of being rejected, of being looked down upon, or of not being taken seriously. This is a problem in you whether or not you realize that you consider it as such and that you battle against it, trying in your own way to solve it. Trying to solve a problem that does not exist must create real problems. The predicament against which you battle is a nonsensical idea, for others are not out to reject or diminish you as you emotionally perceive it ever so often. Whether or not you are aware of it at this moment, nine-tenths of your attitude to life, to yourself, and to others is a struggle against this false premise. To defend yourself against this dreaded happening, an elaborate structure is built.

When you enter upon such a path, and often when you are already on it for some time, without thinking about it specifically, your endeavors in this pathwork are geared to make this dreaded event not come true. In other words, you hope to make your defenses more adequate so as to be better equipped to solve the problem of your rejection and inadequacy -- a problem that does not exist. As long as you move in this direction, real relief cannot come. You must first recognize that all your energies, all your aims are geared into a direction that exists on a false basis. You focus

into illusion, not into reality. When this recognition dawns upon you, you will not project into the future, into a perfection in the future of yourself and your life experience. You will no longer need to strain into being something you are not. The now will then be fully satisfactory. Wherever you stand at that moment, this emptying out must occur!

This emptying consists of recognizing that the problem you struggle against is not a real problem, but an imagination -- an image! Based on this imaginary problem are a number of further general and particular misconceptions and destructive attitudes. For instance, in connection with it, you will find the following factor which I have of course discussed in the past but which needs to be discussed again in this context. When you have a desire or aim which in itself is legitimate and realistic but, in spite of that, remains unfulfilled, what blocks it is the struggle against the nonexistent problem. As a result of the latter, a no-current works against your conscious wishes. It is essential to become specifically aware of this connection.

Whenever an aim for self-expression and fulfillment stubbornly remains unfulfilled, a denying attitude that does not want it, that holds back from it, is overlooked. There is an attitude that, even without saying an outright no to it, refuses to reach for it -- for whatever motivations and reasons. If you do not empty out the fact that you reject your very wish, you cannot eliminate hopelessness which is always a by-product of such an inner situation. As long as you are only aware of your conscious desire and do not see the unconscious withholding of yourself from the desire, there must be hopelessness. The only way you can dissolve the hopelessness is by directly going toward that side in you that says, "No, I do not want it." This still has not occurred to many of my friends, who linger and dwell in their hopelessness. Instead of that, say: "If I feel hopeless because I do not get what I want, where is it in me that I say no to it? I want to and intend to find this denial." Then the hopelessness will dissolve.

The negative attitudes toward the fulfillment must be unearthed, as well as the nonexistent problem that you battle against. Then and then only will blocks dissolve. This is the expressing, the emptying out of your psychic vessel.

As to the second approach, the impressing, the putting in; where you are in untruth, truth must be understood. Behind every untruth, truth exists. It cannot be blotted out or dissolved or made to disappear by erroneous assumptions on your part. But this has to be known. The understanding of what the truth is is extremely important. Now when you discover an untruthful concept, it must be understood what the untruth about it is, in what way is it untruthful, and what is the truthful concept that exists behind it. I once compared this with the sun behind the clouds. If a person lives in a climate where the sun rarely comes out and he forgets that the sun exists, he will become hopeless. But by realizing that the sun exists behind the clouds, there is no hopelessness even while the clouds still prevail. It is the same with truth and untruth. Realize that no matter how negative, how hopeless, how unhappy your momentary moods are, the truth is the opposite. Truth is happiness even if you cannot experience it at the moment. This knowledge, the understanding of this principle, will bring you nearer toward understanding your particular momentary untruth, and the truth behind it.

You cannot impress yourself with a specific truthful concept before you understand your particular untruthful concept. Then and then only is the impressing of your psychic substance feasible. As long as you are confused and do not even know in what way you are in untruth, in what

way the problem you fight against is imaginary, and why this is so, and as long as you ignore the fact that the particular problem you struggle with does not exist in reality, how can you impregnate yourself with the corresponding truthful idea?

The constant interaction between these two approaches is of great importance, my friends. It would be a mistake to assume that these two activities follow each other consecutively on this path -- first expressing, then impressing. Although, up to a certain point, a person's pathwork at first mainly concentrates on bringing out what is inside, while only then does the examination and analysis of this material begin, both expressing and impressing exist throughout, from the beginning onwards. There is no time when both activities are not necessary. Even at the very beginning of such a path when the personality is still filled with misconceptions and utterly unaware of its confusions and what they are, when all this material needs to be expressed; in order to succeed in such expression, it is necessary to comprehend and impress the self with certain, at the time, necessary truthful admonitions and statements. This has the power to gather inner forces and direct these forces into the proper channels. Your intent must be clearly formulated so as to activate the necessary inner powers. This will prevent stagnation and the possibility of giving up in despair and confusion. Hence, even at the early stages when the inner vessel is filled with unclear substance that needs to be emptied out, in order to accomplish this, constant interaction between stating truth and formulating constructive intent (impressing), and expressing must prevail.

As the path advances and progress is made in that the inner vessel brings forth the false ideas, the wrong conclusions, the problems that do not really exist and are fought against on wrong premises, it is even more essential that a harmonious interplay between the two activities exists. The timing of when the one and when the other is appropriate must be found.

There is no rule, my friends, as to when to emphasize more on the one or on the other of these two approaches to the self. The only way you can find into this balance is by feeling into yourself and by listening into the innermost soul movements. By doing that, you will not only come to be very sensitively attuned to the need of the moment in this respect, but you will also strengthen your selfhood. By honoring the rhythm of your personal path, your very individual rhythm, you assume self-responsibility instead of trying to fit into prescribed rules. Your own cosmic attunement can unfold only when it is consciously and deliberately reached for. It cannot reveal itself by ignoring its existence and by blind, rigid practices.

Man is too much bound to obey an authority. We have discussed this amply in the past, but perhaps never quite in this connection. In a very subtle and still vastly undetected way, you go about even such a liberating activity as this pathwork, whose aim it is to attain full selfhood in every possible way, even there you want to go according to prescribed rules, and it does not occur to you to use the material given to you according to the needs of your psyche at this moment. You try to use the material as rules by which to be governed, and this of course has a stifling effect. Even if it cannot kill the vital stream within yourself, this does not encourage its manifestation.

All the lectures, all the material and help given to you on this path must serve only in a way that you freely take only one aspect of it when you feel that it is commensurate and appropriate at a particular moment. In other words, my friends, there is a tremendous difference between trying to use these words at a particular moment, following through, and listening into yourself, freely allowing for what may come up, and then recognizing that the evolving material fits into this or that

lecture or statement of the teachings; as opposed to a very opposite approach, in which too often, in a subtle and unrecognized way, you try to find and squeeze yourself into the tools given you rather than take your inner material first and then choose the tool afterwards. The latter approach will make you free, while the former continues to bind you. Only the authority has changed, not you and your attitudes. This becomes even more confusing because everything you learn and hear points to liberation and selfhood and self-responsibility. Therefore it is easy to overlook the subtle bondage by squeezing your soul movements into patterns and stages of this work rather than by letting out and then seeing the stage into which it fits. In order to do that, you have to have the courage, my friends, to listen into yourself, to tune in on your soul movements, and then decide: "Am I now more in need of emptying out because heaviness and depression indicate that I ignore what really bothers me, or do I need to instruct myself?"

This instruction may also be necessary when it is important to empty out, but its character is completely different. Impressing the need for expressing, for facing what dwells inside, for overcoming resistance and the unreality of fear to do so means using impression in order to be better capable of expression. At the stages when expression has sufficiently taken place, the nature of impression is that of stating the truthful idea and concept as opposed to the hitherto false one.

To recapitulate, impressing has two distinct facets. The one helps to overcome resistance to expressing. The other reorients and rebuilds the inner personality by deliberate formulation of truth, by profound understanding of it, as opposed to the untruth.

Reorientation of negative and destructive consciousness can take place only when it is understood that there is an inner struggle against a nonexistent problem, and that struggle is finally given up. Whenever you come to this understanding, the second type of impressing is necessary. Without it, the understanding fades away for a while, and your old, habit bound emotions still revert to the fright of long standing, in blind automatism. Only knowing the truth will prevent this. In order to know the truth, the now empty vessel has to be filled with it so as to prevent its being refilled with untruth.

This intercourse between your outer mind and your innermost self, and finding the proper rhythm and balance between impressing and expressing, and which kind of impressing is to be used at what juncture -- that is the aim. When you go into your periods of meditation and concentration in this work, listen into yourself, into your soul movements. Instruct the deepest strata of your psyche that you want to properly express and that you also request and wish awareness of when to impress and when to express and how to do either. Request inspiration as to the extent that your volitional mind has to function and to what extent and when you must let go of your volitional mind and let yourself flow, and observe what is coming out. This selfhood, trusting your own soul movements, will exist in the measure that you overcome the sluggish soul movements that want to prevent you, in false fears, under false premises, from doing just that. This is why the imaginary problem that you fight against, with its concomitant false fears, keeps you from the dynamic living that results from this path.

Find, my friends, this interaction. Once you are well launched on this intercourse between the volitional impressing and the soul movement that expresses from deep within, you will find a deep harmony and a deep reason to trust your innermost self. For then the forces, the creativity, the positive elements, which could not truly express heretofore, will more and more guide you towards

the light you seek. The struggle will be finished. Not growing will be finished, not an end to learning and extending yourself, but to the useless struggle.

Are there any questions regarding this topic?

QUESTION: Would you say that the action of emptying is the surrender of the outer self saying, "I am in confusion, I ask to know from Supreme Will and Supreme Intelligence what is the truth in this?" -- and that the impressing is the uniting, the identifying with this inner intelligence, this true, higher self, in acting with the force purely as it comes from the source, without distortion, without imaging, without limiting? Is that the way it goes?

ANSWER: That is quite right. In fact, what I said at the very end, just now, is exactly that. You see, as long as man is in this false struggle, the struggle that is based on nonsensical premises -- and I deliberately call it by such a strong name because, for every one of your images, if you examine them from this point of view, you will recognize that the premise itself is nonsensical -- man must be divided within himself. This is not only concerning motivations, energy currents going into conflicting directions, but he is primarily separated from this highest self of wisdom, intelligence, strength, happiness, love, abundance. Everything good that exists in the universe is in man. But he cannot reach this source, which is yet so near, unless he realizes the false struggle and understands it. This can happen only when he turns inward and allows himself to listen to his soul movements. Unless he requests this source to manifest, he will remain ignorant of it. His outer, volitional intelligence must call this deep inner intelligence into play. Thus the two will unify after all the material is absorbed that keep the two separated. Then integration will occur. That is the aim. So long as man harbors false ideas, the original oneness is split. On either side, as it were, one set of intelligence exists. The two can melt when the outer, conscious one deliberately reaches toward the inner, still hidden one, removing those false elements that have created the split in the first place. Only through such a path as I show you can this goal be accomplished.

I should like to take a frequent situation in order to demonstrate this point. Let us assume you are tired and depressed, hopeless and at the point of giving up your efforts because your struggle does not bring relief. You do not wish to do so, but just cannot see a way in which to seek. This stagnation is a result of your energies being geared to the unconscious false struggle -- now, what to do? Instead of going on struggling on a conscious level by forcing yourself to adopt truths your psyche is as yet unable to absorb, the simple realization that this highest of all wisdom must exist in you -- even if at the moment you do not feel it and perhaps even doubt its existence -- will open the way. Honestly acknowledge your doubt, but also honestly allow for its possibility. It is nevertheless possible to request its guidance while truly being open to it. But what usually happens, my friends, is that when you examine yourself in such a situation, you do not even get to the point of considering to reach for this higher source of wisdom within yourself. It does not occur to you although you have discussed it many times and know of its theoretical existence. Why not? If you look deeper inside, you will find that at such moments you do not even want to believe that this highest source of intelligence and beauty exists in you. You do not want it. For some strange reason, you even fight against its admission. As long as you are unaware of this, again you cannot truly give up this false struggle. There is something in you not wanting to accept this possibility.

You must come to the point of ascertaining this tiny little voice, saying no to the possibility of its own higher consciousness. It is even frightened of that marvelous truth that you carry all you need and can possibly wish for within yourself.

Now, my friends, I do not mean by that that you can get to such realizations without help -- of course not. In order to find this perfect Source, help is necessary. Since a healthy balance between expressing and impressing does not mean the one versus the other, so a healthy balance between accepting help and accepting self-responsibility does not mean the one versus the other. The two, in both instances, are not mutually exclusive but interact in harmonious interplay. To the degree you learn the harmonious interplay in both instances, your innermost self becomes your outer self. There is no longer separation or conflict between the two. The superimposed intellect, the outer intelligence is filled with, motivated, and moved by this inner Source of All, the original Source of All -- which is in you, thus must never, never be forgotten. It exists in you, right now and is immediately accessible. To the degree that you know it, to that degree can it manifest.

QUESTION: What you have just expressed so perfectly fits the stage where I am at present and with which we are concerned in my private work. I have a feeling that I have such a fear of this self-responsibility. Is that true?

ANSWER: Yes, indeed. Of course, this fits into the phase many of my friends are in now. In your case, there is, as you very correctly surmise, a great, great fear of self-responsibility. The fear is of course completely unjustified. It may help you if I show the following. Because you are afraid of self-responsibility, you are constantly dependent on circumstances outside your control. Therefore you feel helpless. You feel like a straw in the wind, having no power over life and circumstances. Now, that much you know. But in order to understand this a little better, it is important to see the following. Perhaps you will still feel an echo this evening. You are so afraid to acknowledge this highest Source of All, the key to all life within yourself -- perfect wisdom, intelligence, strength, and beauty -- because somehow you feel that this would be wrongly proud. You fear that the mere consideration of such a possibility would infer overestimation of yourself, giving yourself airs that you do not deserve. The possibility that you can harbor such powers within might mean gross overvaluation. This you fear. In order to be a good, obeying child, you negate this possibility. You are afraid of the pride for which you may then be punished, as well as of the disappointment. You do not take a chance of being disappointed, and therefore you cannot find the truth of it. Does that ring a bell?

Perhaps you can now approach this problem with this new understanding. Ask yourself, "Am I willing to take a chance? I cannot be worse off than I am now. I do not need unjustified hope. Even if my doubts that I do not have these powers and this Source within me should be justified, it is better to know and go on from there than keeping this possibility constantly dangling as a theory I do not ever dare to explore." In other words, commit yourself honestly to this problem of your doubting. As long as you doubt and do not give the positive side a chance, you do not honestly commit yourself to the problem. How can a problem be resolved or dissolved if one does not give it every chance through a full commitment to it? The full honest commitment is in testing it again and again. Such fair testing cannot be terminated the day after tomorrow because too many misconceptions and false fears clog up the channel. Giving the full chance means deliberately reaching inside to contact this Source for the immediate purpose of this pathwork, of self-realization, of creative living. Honest testing means an attitude of "I give the possibility every

chance." It does not say no to it before such a chance is extended, in the false assumption that disappointment will then hurt less. Apart from the fact that this is not so, disappointment is unavoidable when you deny the Source before open-heartedly trying.

You, and so many people, are constantly in a negativity because you do not dare to find out once and for all, "Is it positive or is it negative? Is it true or is it not true?" They negate before they find a true basis for accepting because they are so afraid that their acceptance may prove disappointing. This is a very general situation. Have the courage to assume the possibility for a positive alternative.

QUESTION: You speak of the outer self as "the child." Is it not the very essence of the whole thing that the child must mature? And, in order for maturity to take place, for this growth pattern to be fulfilled, there is this transition, this uniting with the higher self?

ANSWER: Yes. Only it might be misleading to believe that the child is always necessarily the outer self. This might not always be quite accurate. The child exists between a superimposed, or partly superimposed, intellectual maturity, and this highest Source of all wisdom and happiness. It dwells in between. It is not completely outer or inner. It is relative as to the position of the viewer. In other words, when you consider it from the outer maturity, from the level of where you know better, the child is inner. When you consider it from the point of view of the innermost real self, it is outer. It is important to understand that because the outer maturity -- which may be in part a genuine, integrated maturity but interspersed with a false, superimposed -- merely intellectual maturity, not cemented by the emotional experience in certain respects, must try to ally itself with the real self in the endeavor to teach the "child" the truth. The outer maturity must not be confused with the real self. It reaches up to a certain level, but where that level ends, the stubborn lost child, battling against false premises, exists. To bring out this child in its full irrationality and ignorance is the expressing that I talked about. In order for the child to grow up, it must learn what is true and what is false.

Many of you see the wrong conclusions partly, but it is still a haphazard realization because the entirety of the wrong assumption, that the problem itself is nonexistent, is still often overlooked. That comprehension must be attained.

I say, my friends, whenever you are really stuck on this path, when you are in great anxiety, in a resistance that seems insurmountable, you can be quite sure that this in itself is a wrong conclusion. For, you inordinately fear something that has no existence. Nothing true needs ever be feared in such a way. Wherever progress has been made on this path, it was proven to be so, you have found it to be so. You have found that your actual faults never induce this despair. Despair is a result of an untruthful verdict you have pronounced against yourself or the world. It is connected with an imaginary problem. Unfortunately, even though this fact was already ascertained by some of my friends, it might be forgotten the next time until it has been recaptured on the next level.

May the material I have given you -- the lecture as well as the answers to your questions -- give you new incentive for all of you who try and work so hard on your path of self-realization, of coming into your own. Then you will find within you that which you falsely believed to be far away.

My dearest friends, be blessed, and may these blessings, which are an actuality, be able to reach everything in you that needs to be activated in order to find yourself. Be in peace! Realize the truth, which is so liberating, namely that there is nothing to fear, that fear and unhappiness are error. Be in God!

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